

LATIN AMERICAN STUDIES CERTIFICATE

Interdepartmental Undergraduate Program

The certificate in Latin American Studies is a cross-disciplinary course of study in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences and is designed for undergraduates in any major who wish to enhance their degree and employment possibilities by adding expertise in Latin America and competence in the Spanish language.

Objectives

- Provide opportunities for students to develop skills and understanding about issues concerning Latin America by bringing them into contact with faculty members from many different academic backgrounds
- Provide students with an international immersion experience where they gain cultural awareness and sensitivity
- Prepare students for work or advanced study in Latin America, such as in foreign service, journalism, advocacy organizations, scientific or research institutions
- Help students acquire proficiency in one of the principal languages of Latin America (Spanish)
- Guide students in interdisciplinary study leading to an understanding of the multi-faceted picture of the past, present, and future of Latin America

Learning Outcomes

Upon Completion of the Certificate in Latin American Studies, students will be able to:

- Demonstrate understanding of key concepts pertaining to Latin American cultural, historical and political events
- Understand, interpret and articulate the major processes, theories and problems of selected contemporary and historical issues in Latin America
- Demonstrate oral, aural, and written proficiency in Spanish equivalent to the mid-advanced level
- Effectively communicate with persons of Latin American cultures
- Become effective global citizens through knowledge and comparison of the cultures and issues of the United States and Latin American countries
- Be able to read Latin American cultural, literary, and historical texts in the target language with comprehension and analytical insight
- Demonstrate awareness of cultural values, beliefs, and ideologies of the various Latin American countries

- Demonstrate a thorough knowledge of the geography of the Latin American countries

General Requirements

Requirements for the Certificate in Latin American Studies are satisfied through formal language instruction and by completing a minimum of 21 credits at the 3000 level or above. Students will take coursework in at least three different disciplines and departments (Spanish, Anthropology, and Political Science) with other possible course offerings in LAS, History, Agriculture, and Agronomy.

Course Requirements

Students will complete 6 credits of core courses:

SPAN 3220	Latin American Civilization	3
or SPAN 3240	Latin America Today	
ANTHR 3230	Latin American Anthropology	3

Students should consult with their advisor for alternative courses in the event a course is not available.

Other Requirements

In addition to University policies (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>) governing certificates, this certificate has the following specific requirements:

- Students will complete an additional 15 credits selected from the approved list of courses in Latin American Studies or courses approved by the Latin American Studies Certificate advisor at the 3000 level or above.
- No more than 3 credits may be taken as a 4900, independent study, and the topic must deal with Latin America.

LANGUAGE REQUIREMENT

- The minimum requirement in formal language instruction is completion of two years or the equivalent of Spanish at the university level. At ISU the completion of Spanish 2020 satisfies this requirement.
- Native speakers, or those with in-field experience of another Latin American language with a level equivalent to 2020 or higher can have the language requirement waived. Equivalence will normally be assessed by a faculty member/CLEP exam in the Dept. of World Languages and Cultures.
- While students are encouraged to enroll in language instruction courses (i.e., conversation and composition) above the 3000 level, no more than 6 credits of language study (3030,3040,3050) may be applied toward fulfilling language requirements for the Certificate. Students should be aware that all 3000-level literature and culture/civilization courses in the Dept. of World Languages and Cultures have prerequisites.

Study Abroad

Students are required to participate in an ISU-approved study abroad program in a Latin American country with a minimum duration of 4 consecutive weeks. The Study Abroad Office has a list of ISU-approved programs. Students may elect to participate in other study abroad programs with the approval of the Latin American Studies Advisory Committee.

Approved courses available toward the Certificate:

The decision as to whether or not a course can be counted toward the certificate is based primarily on course title and description as it appears in the current ISU course catalog. Courses which primarily deal with Spain or Portugal and their cultures do not count toward the certificate. Students should consult with the advisor for the Latin American Studies Undergraduate Certificate program before registering to be sure a particular travel course or field school offering can apply toward the certificate.

AGEDS 4960A	International	1-3
	or AGEDS 4960B Domestic	
AGRON 4960A	International Tour	1-30
	or AGRON 4960C Domestic Tour	
ANTHR 3230		3
ANTHR 4450	Biological Field School	4-6
	or ANTHR 5450 Biological Field School	
HIST 3400	Colonial Latin America	3
HIST 3410	Modern Latin America	3
INTST 3950A	Interdisciplinary Study Abroad: Pre-Departure Seminar	1
	or INTST 3950B Interdisciplinary Study Abroad: Humanities	
	or INTST 3950C Interdisciplinary Study Abroad: Communications	
	or INTST 3950D Interdisciplinary Study Abroad: Mathematics and Natural Science	
	or INTST 3950E Interdisciplinary Study Abroad: Social Sciences	
POLS 3430	Latin American Government and Politics	3
SPAN 3220	Latin American Civilization	3
SPAN 3240	Latin America Today	3
SPAN 3260	Studies in Hispanic Art or Film	3
SPAN 3320	Studies in Latin American Literature	3
SPAN 3700A	Hispanic Topics in English Translation: Agriculture	3
	or SPAN 3700S Studies in English Translation: Hispanic Topics on Women or Feminism	
SPAN 3950	Study Abroad	1-10
SPAN 4450	Seminar on the Literatures and Cultures of Latin America	3

SPAN 4630	Contemporary Spanish Linguistics	3
SPAN 4990	Internship in Spanish	1-3